

COMP3018 – Human-Robot Interaction

Week 10 – Facial Expression Detection (Part - 2)

Semester 2, 2025-2026

The purpose of this workshop is to work on a dataset of facial expressions and train a neural network model to recognize emotions. This exercise builds on the theoretical knowledge you learned in the module **COMP3018**.

Exercise 1

Emotion detection is a challenging task, because emotions are subjective. There is no common consensus on how to measure or categorize them. In this exercise, we will learn - in a live demo - how to recognize facial expressions using a trained deep-learning model.

- In the last week, we created and trained a deep-learning model for detecting facial expressions. After running the model for **15 iterations**, we achieved an **accuracy of 68 %** (more iterations can make the accuracy higher). With this accuracy and model, we will try today to make a **live demo** using our PC camera to recognize our facial expressions.
- Download the model parameter files from the DLE, and in the same folder create a new python script called **Face_demo.py**, which will read the parameter files **model.weights.h5** and **model.json** of the model that we trained in the last workshop.
- In the python file, create a class called **FacialExpressionModel** that aim at reading the parameters of the trained model.

```
6 import numpy as np
7 import cv2
8 import tensorflow as tf
9 from IPython.display import SVG, Image
10 from livelossplot.inputs.tf_keras import PlotLossesCallback
11 from tensorflow.keras.models import model_from_json
12
13 class FacialExpressionModel(object):
14     EMOTIONS_LIST = ["Angry", "Disgust",
15                     "Fear", "Happy",
16                     "Neutral", "Sad",
17                     "Surprise"]
18     def __init__(self, model_json_file, model_weights_file):
19         # load model from JSON file
20         with open(model_json_file, "r") as json_file:
21             loaded_model_json = json_file.read()
22             self.loaded_model = model_from_json(loaded_model_json)
23         # load weights into the new model
24         self.loaded_model.load_weights(model_weights_file)
25         self.loaded_model.make_predict_function()
26     def predict_emotion(self, img):
27         self.preds = self.loaded_model.predict(img)
28         return FacialExpressionModel.EMOTIONS_LIST[np.argmax(self.preds)]
29
30 model = FacialExpressionModel("model.json", "model_weights.h5")
```

- Afterward, create a classe called **VideoCamera** that aim at using the trained model to predict, live, the emotion of a facial expression using the camera of the PC. This class detects the human face with a rectangle using OpenCV features.

```

32 facec = cv2.CascadeClassifier('haarcascade_frontalface_default.xml')
33 font = cv2.FONT_HERSHEY_SIMPLEX
34
35 class VideoCamera(object):
36     def __init__(self):
37         self.video = cv2.VideoCapture(0)
38     def __del__(self):
39         self.video.release()
40     # returns camera frames along with bounding boxes and predictions
41     def get_frame(self):
42         _, fr = self.video.read()
43         gray_fr = cv2.cvtColor(fr, cv2.COLOR_BGR2GRAY)
44         faces = facec.detectMultiScale(gray_fr, 1.3, 5)
45         for (x, y, w, h) in faces:
46             fc = gray_fr[y:y+h, x:x+w]
47             roi = cv2.resize(fc, (48, 48))
48             pred = model.predict_emotion(roi[np.newaxis, :, :, np.newaxis])
49             cv2.putText(fr, pred, (x, y), font, 1, (255, 255, 0), 2)
50             cv2.rectangle(fr, (x,y),(x+w,y+h),(255,0,0),2)
51         return fr
52
53 def gen(camera):
54     while True:
55         frame = camera.get_frame()
56         cv2.imshow('Facial Expression Recognition', frame)
57         if cv2.waitKey(1) & 0xFF == ord('q'):
58             break
59     cv2.destroyAllWindows()
60
61 gen(VideoCamera())

```

- Run the code, and evaluate if the system will be able to recognize your different facial expressions or not.